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SUB-SOIL INVESTIGATION REPORT FOR PROPOSED CONSTRUCTION OF 05 STORIED RESIDENTIAL BUILDING AT PIRMOHOLLA, SADAR, SYLHET

DAG # SA-1043, BS-131, KHA # SA-464, BS-2694
J.L # SA-92, BS-74, MOUJA # AMBORKHANA

CLIENT

H.U. FAROOQUE IBN AMBIA
S/O- MR. A. AMBIA

CONDUCTED BY

CENTER FOR RESEARCH TESTING & CONSULTANCY
DEPARTMENT OF CIVIL & ENVIRONMENTAL ENGINEERING
SHAHJALAL UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY, SYLHET

Sample Collected by
M/S TECHNO SOIL INVESTIGATIOR
Mokothchhor Market, Bagbari Barnomala Point, Sylhet
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Introduction

A reasonably accurate conception about the sub-soil parameters of any project site is an essential prerequisite for proper planning and designing the foundation of the structure so that the same after its construction would remain safe and serviceable. A detailed study on the sub-surface elements in this regard would necessary to select proper type of foundation.

Objectives

The purpose of sub-soil investigation program is to obtain the following information

1. To classify the formation of soil layers
2. To estimate the safe bearing capacities of the foundation at different soil layers
3. To suggest the safe and appropriate type of foundations.

Scope of work

Centre for research, testing and consultancy (CRTC), Department of Civil and Environmental Engineering, Shahjalal University of Science & Technology (SUST), Sylhet; execute only the laboratory tests and other computational works with the supplied disturbed and/or undisturbed samples to determine the geotechnical properties of the soil.

Table 1: Items of the supplied samples

No	Name	Bore hole no	Depth	Quantities
01	Disturbed sample	01	0-25 ft	5
02	Disturbed sample	02	0-30 ft	6
03	Disturbed sample	03	0-30 ft	6

Laboratory Classifications

The disturbed soil samples, supplied by the client were thoroughly examined and classified roughly (color and type) and noted in accordance with bore hole (BH) and depth (Please see enclosed Tables).

Laboratory Works & Analysis

In addition to visual examination of the sample, Bearing Capacity of soil samples including skin friction & end bearing were calculated.

Bearing capacity for shallow foundation

The N value gives useful information with regards to consistency of cohesive soil and relative density of cohesion less soil. These relationships are given in the following Tables for cohesive and cohesion less soil, respectively.

Table 2: Relation of N-value with the Consistency and the Unconfined Compressive Strength of Cohesive Soils (after Bowles 1997)

N-values	Consistency	Unconfined Compressive Strength (q_u)	
		tsf	kPa
0-2	Very soft	0 to 0.25	0 to 25
3-5	Soft	0.25 to 0.50	25 to 50
6-9	Medium	0.50 to 1	50 to 100
10-16	Stiff	1 to 2	100 to 200
17-30	Very stiff	2 to 4	200 to 400
>30	Hard	>4	>400

Table 3: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Fine Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
1 – 2	Very Loose	0 – 15	26 – 28	70 – 100
3 – 6	Loose	15 – 35	28 – 30	90 – 115
7 – 15	Medium	35 – 65	30 – 34	110 – 130
16 – 30	Dense	65 – 85	33 – 38	110 – 140
>30	Very Dense	>85	>50	130 – 150

Table 4: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Medium Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
2 – 3	Very Loose	0 – 15	27 – 28	70 – 100
4 – 7	Loose	15 – 35	30 – 32	90 – 115
8 – 20	Medium	35 – 65	32 – 36	110 – 130
21 – 40	Dense	65 – 85	36 – 42	110 – 140

Table 5: N and ϕ Relation to Relative Density for Coarse Sand (after Bowles 1997)

N values	Compactness	Relative Density, Dr %	ϕ (degree)	Unit Weight (pcf)
3 – 6	Very Loose	0 – 15	28 – 30	70 – 100
5 – 9	Loose	15 – 35	30 – 34	90 – 115
10 – 25	Medium	35 – 65	33 – 40	110 – 130
26 – 40	Dense	65 – 85	40 – 50	110 – 140
>40	Very Dense	>85	>50	130 – 150

Bearing capacity for deep foundation

Foundations, preferably piles are considered to transmit heavy load from superstructure to deep and hard strata. As the formation of soil strata consists of cohesive and non-cohesive type, the evaluation criteria for the determination of skin friction and the end bearing capacities of piles also vary. Details of the evaluation are provided in the following sub-headings.

Table 6: Formula Used to Determine Bearing Capacity of Soil

Shallow Foundation	
For Cohesive Soil	
$q_a = q_u + \gamma \frac{D}{3}$ $q_a = q_u$(Common Practice)	Where, q_a=Allowable bearing capacity, q_u= Unconfined Compressive Strength, γ= Unit Weight of soil, D= Depth of footing
For Cohesion less Soil	
$q_{ult} = 30N$; $q_a = q_{ult}/FS$	q_{ult}= Ultimate bearing capacity in kPa, N = SPT Number, FS= Factor of Safety
Source: Bowles, J. E., "Physical and Geotechnical Properties of Soils", 2nd Edition	
Deep Foundation	
For Cohesive Soil	
$f_{su} = \alpha C_u$; $q_{pu} = N_c C_u$	α = Adhesion factor, f_{su} = Ultimate skin friction, C_u = Undrained Shear Strength, q_{pu} = Ultimate end bearing of pile, N_c = Bearing capacity factor for deep foundation=9
For Cohesion less Soil	
$f_{su} = N/50\ tsf$; $q_{pu} = 4N\ tsf$	f_{su} = Ultimate skin friction, q_{pu} = Ultimate end bearing of pile, N = SPT Number
Source: Rajapakse RA (2008), "Geotechnical Engineering Calculations and Rules of Thumb"	

Based on the above formula, the important parameters for foundation design have been determined and are given in **Table 7**, **Table 8, Table 9, Table 10 and Table 11** respectively.

Table 7: The allowable bearing capacity for shallow foundation in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Bore Hole No.	Depth	Design N	Clay						Sand
			Continuous			Square(Isolated)			
	(ft)	-	D/B=0.25	D/B=0.5	D/B=1	D/B=0.25	D/B=0.5	D/B=1	
BH01	2.5-5.0	19	2.181	2.294	2.500	2.576	2.782	3.027	2.350
	5.0-10	25	2.844	2.991	3.261	3.359	3.629	3.947	3.065
BH02	2.5-5.0	15	1.694	1.781	1.942	2.000	2.161	2.351	1.825
	5.0-10	20	2.372	2.495	2.720	2.801	3.026	3.292	2.556
BH03	2.5-5.0	9	1.090	1.147	1.250	1.288	1.391	1.513	1.175
	5.0-10	17	1.976	2.078	2.266	2.334	2.521	2.743	2.129

Table 8: The allowable skin friction for Precast driven piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole		
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03
5	0.049	0.025	0.025
10	0.152	0.136	0.138
15	0.216	0.152	0.136
20	0.216	0.200	0.216
25	0.248	0.208	0.248
30	-	0.232	0.232

Table 9: The allowable end bearing for Precast driven piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole		
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03
5	0.450	0.225	0.225
10	30.400	27.200	1.350
15	43.200	30.400	27.200
20	43.200	40.000	43.200
25	49.600	41.600	49.600
30	-	46.400	46.400

Table 10: The allowable skin friction for Bored piles in Tsf (FS=2.5)

Depth	Bore Hole		
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03
5	0.032	0.016	0.016
10	0.099	0.088	0.090
15	0.140	0.099	0.088
20	0.140	0.130	0.140
25	0.161	0.135	0.161
30	-	0.151	0.151

Table 11: The allowable end bearing for Bored piles in Tsf (FS=3.0)

Depth	Bore Hole		
ft	BH01	BH02	BH03
5	0.203	0.101	0.101
10	13.680	12.240	0.608
15	19.440	13.680	12.240
20	19.440	18.000	19.440
25	22.320	18.720	22.320
30	-	20.880	20.880

CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

On the basis of analysis and information provided by the owner following recommendations are suggested for the proposed three storied residential building.

Soil profile scenario

Overall soil information of the investigated site is almost regular in between the boreholes and but vertical inconsistency exists in the soil formation.

Brown sandy clay with low bearing capacity exists at the upper layers followed by Brown fine sand with silt & clay with moderate bearing capacity. Brown fine sand with good bearing capacity was found after 15 ft depth from EGL. Detailed scenario is provided with the report (please see attached bore-log profiles with SPT values).

Foundation options

In this situation, the foundation should be selected considering both the dimension and design load for the proposed building. Since brown fine sand with silt & clay with moderate bearing capacity exists below 5- 10 ft from EGL, shallow footing can be adopted at that layer. The bearing capacity for shallow foundation is given in the table 7 based on existing soil condition. However, size and depth of the pile should be selected in the light of bearing capacity given in the report (Tables 8 and 9 are for precast piles; Tables 10 and 11 are for cast in situ piles), if deep foundation (piles) is selected for this case.

Safety provisions

It is strongly recommended to check the **settlement** of the site considering building load while designing either shallow or deep foundation. Obviously **pile load test** covering the entire project area must be carried out for confirming the design parameters of the service pile (*if pile foundation is considered*). Moreover, the earthquake vulnerability of the project area as well as the quality management of the construction work including workmanship should be taken into account for the safe design of shallow or deep foundation.

Attachments

The layout of the bore holes of the investigated site and the bore-log profiles with SPT values is shown in the Appendix. Client performed no special laboratory test for the proposed site.

Special notes

These suggestions are absolutely tentative and selection of type, depth and dimensions of foundation would be decided by the Consultant or Design Engineer. It is also to be noted that the above recommendation is restricted only to the existing soil condition of **25-30** ft as client provided.

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